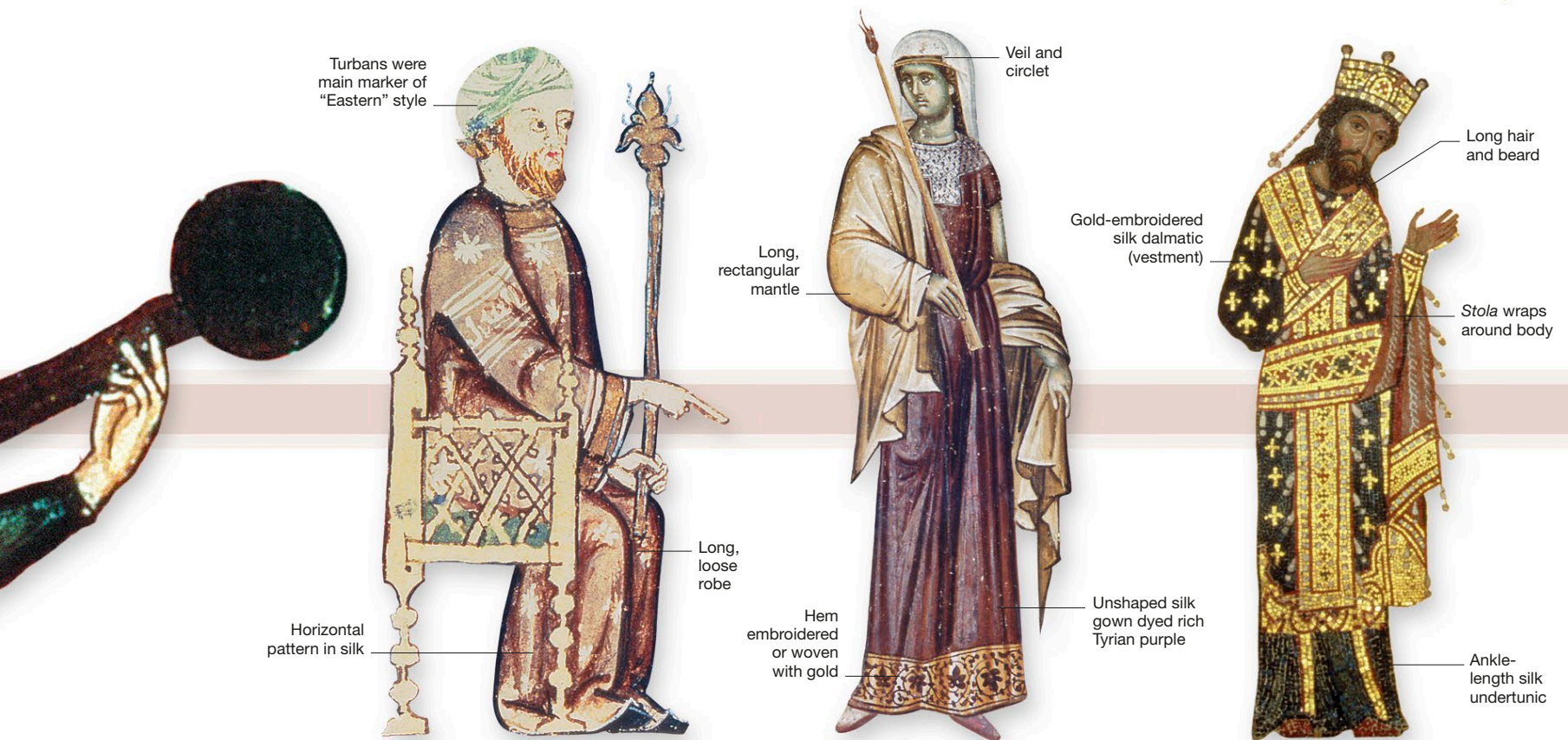
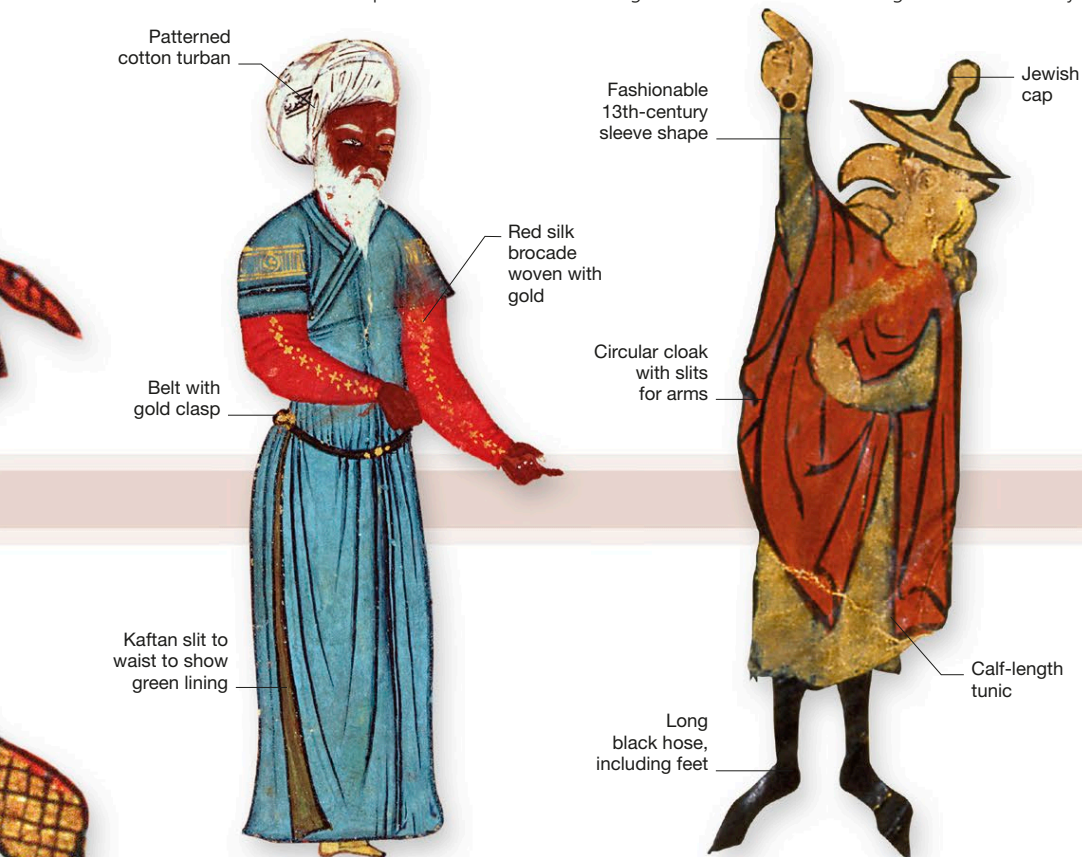




Turbaned king Alfonso X, king of Castile and León 1252–84, sits in a Moorish turban and robe to rule his northern Spanish Christian kingdoms. At that time, half of the Iberian peninsula was a Muslim kingdom.

Serbian matron The Eastern Orthodox women's dress of the 14th century shows a continuation of classical styles, not the fitted clothing of Western Europe. This reflects the kingdom's link with Byzantine traditions.

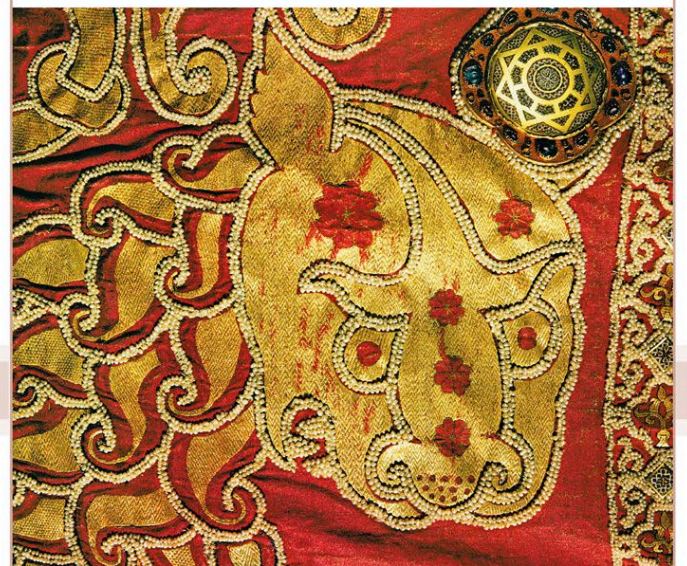
Byzantine splendour Norman King Roger II of Sicily wears Byzantine imperial clothing for his 1133 coronation. The magnificent wide gold band encrusted with pearls and precious stones is a long *stola* (scarf) wrapped around his body.



Persian kaftan An older African man wears a kaftan with a diagonal wrap front, a style never seen in European dress. This was worn all across Asia as far as China. Islamic men and women's clothing often had the same feature.

Jewish dress This figure from a Jewish text known as the *Bird's Head Haggadah* (c.1300) shows the cap sometimes worn by Jewish men. Christian countries often made people of other faiths identify themselves with specific clothing.

SICILIAN SILK



Crusading travellers who visited the Middle Eastern Latin kingdoms were astonished at the quantities of silk worn there. One renowned centre for silk weaving was Sicily. When King Roger II of Sicily was crowned, his clothing included a semicircular silk coronation mantle made in Palermo's royal workshops. This valuable treasure is embroidered in gold with symmetrical patterns of lions attacking camels – symbolizing Normans versus Saracens. Each animal is outlined with hundreds of seed pearls. The inscription around the edge is in Arabic calligraphy.